



» COVER STORY

FEARLESS AND FORMIDABLE

Sanju Samson and Jasprit Bumrah headlined a **ruthless campaign** as India clinched its third T20 World Cup title and fifth across formats.

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In cricket's slimmest format, India is leaving its largest footprint. The Men in Blue ticked many boxes as they retained the ICC T20 World Cup after a lopsided final against New Zealand at Ahmedabad's Narendra Modi Stadium on an adrenaline-soaked Sunday.

There was no case of the ides of March scuppering the team as Suryakumar Yadav and his troops dished out a commanding performance to keep the final well beyond the reach of the Black Caps. India's 255 for five in the

summit clash was mounted on decisive batting that targeted the boundary ropes and beyond.

"There is no point just scoring 160 or 170, the team has to go past 200 often," coach Gautam Gambhir said. His wards largely followed that dictum through the campaign, posting four 200-plus scores, including three that crossed the 250-mark. The top-three of Sanju Samson (89), Abhishek Sharma and Ishan Kishan amassed the runs and, even after a middle-overs wobble, India found a strong tailwind through Shivam Dube.

New Zealand was never in the chase as its leading batters pursued